

What I actually use on my face

Nothing fancy, nothing expensive. The stuff that stayed in my routine because it worked.

FROM A PHYSICIAN ASSISTANT, AND A MOM OF THREE WHO DOES THIS AT 6AM

I bought the expensive serum. The viral one. It did nothing, and it cost more than the first three products on this list put together.

So this is the honest version. Everything here is under twenty dollars, most of it is under sixteen, and I rebuy all of it.

#ad — I earn commission on some of these products when people buy them through my links elsewhere. It costs you nothing extra, and I only put things on this list that are actually in my house.

THE THREE THAT REPLACED THE EXPENSIVE ONE

BYOMA Hydrating Serum

\$15.99 · squalane, glycerin, ceramides

This is the one I reach for every morning. It is the dupe I found after the expensive serum did nothing, and it costs about a third of what that one did.

BYOMA Moisturizing Gel Cream

\$13.99 · niacinamide, ceramides

The moisturizer. It is a gel so it does not sit on my skin feeling heavy, which is the reason I actually keep using it instead of letting it die in a drawer.

BYOMA Bio-Collagen Radiance Facial Mask

\$16.99

One or two nights a week. This is my little self-care night. It leaves my skin feeling hydrated and refreshed and that is the whole claim I am making.

THE PATCHES, WHICH ARE MY FAVORITE UNGLAMOROUS THING

Okela Collagen Forehead Patches

I sleep in them

I put these on before bed and forget about them. They are not Botox and I am not telling you they are. I just like my forehead better on the mornings after.

CLEVERFY Silicone Chest Patches

For side-sleeping

If you sleep on your side you already know why this exists. I pair it with the firming cream I already had.

PanOxyl Blemish Brightening Patches

For the dark mark that stays behind after the spot is gone, which is honestly the part that bothers me more than the spot did.

Differin Acne Patches

salicylic acid + centella

Adult breakouts are real and nobody warns you. Drugstore price, and I keep a box in the bathroom drawer.

THE CHEAPEST HABIT CHANGE ON THIS PAGE

Disposable face towels, 100 count

Not exciting. But a clean towel every single time instead of the one hanging on the hook, and it is the change that cost the least out of anything on this list.

One thing I took off this list on purpose. I had an expensive PDNA serum in my history and I removed it, because it did not do anything for me and I would not recommend it. Bought is not the same as endorsed.

This is my own routine, not medical advice, and not a promise about what anything will do for you. Talk to your own provider about your own situation.